POCKETBOT COMPLETE BEGINNER USER MANUAL

Automated Multi-Market Trading Assistant for Windows and MetaTrader 5

Zero Coding Knowledge Required — Complete Setup, Plain-English Profit Math, Safety Limits, 1-Click Buttons, PowerShell Commands, Antigravity AI Guide, and Troubleshooting.

1. Welcome: What Is PocketBot?

PocketBot is an automated market-scanning and trade-execution program that runs on a Windows computer and connects directly to the free MetaTrader 5 (MT5) desktop trading platform.

Instead of guessing, gambling, or staring at charts all day, PocketBot acts like a disciplined, emotionless assistant. It watches 10 major global markets simultaneously, checks live price candles, runs 10,000 mathematical practice replays before risking a single dollar, calculates exact trade sizes automatically, and enforces 5 hard safety circuit breakers so one bad afternoon can never wipe out your account.

Key highlights before you start:

- **100% Free Demo Practice Mode by Default:** PocketBot is hard-locked to Demo (fake practice money) accounts out of the box. It physically refuses to place real-money orders unless manually unlocked by an advanced command flag.
- **$0 Monthly Cost to Run:** Once installed on your computer, running PocketBot every day uses free Python and free MetaTrader 5. No paid subscriptions or paid data feeds are required for daily trading.

2. Computer, Software, and Account Requirements

Before starting, verify that the computer meets every item below:

Requirement	Minimum Specification	Why It Matters
Operating System	Windows 10 or Windows 11 (64-bit)	MetaTrader 5's official Python bridge ONLY works on 64-bit Windows. It will NOT work on Apple Mac, Chromebook, iPad, Android, or iPhone.
Memory (RAM)	4 GB RAM minimum (8 GB+ recommended)	Needed to run MetaTrader 5 and the 10,000-replay simulation engine smoothly.
Disk Storage	2 GB free space on C: drive	Stores Python 3.12, MetaTrader 5, Antigravity CLI, and trade log files.

Requirement	Minimum Specification	Why It Matters
Internet	Stable Wi-Fi or Ethernet cable	Streams live market prices and sends orders to the broker server.
Power and Sleep	Plugged into charger; Sleep set to Never	**CRITICAL:** If Windows goes to sleep or you close the laptop lid, Windows freezes all programs and PocketBot stops scanning.
Free Programs	MetaTrader 5, Python 3.12, Node.js, Antigravity CLI	All four are free downloads. Exact copy-paste install commands are provided in Section 5.
Accounts Needed	Free MT5 Demo Account + Google Account	Demo account is created inside MT5 in 30 seconds (no ID or credit card). Google account is used only when opening the Antigravity (agy) AI helper to edit settings (Google AI Pro gives higher AI editing limits, while daily bot operation uses zero AI quota).

Critical Pre-Step: Turn Off Windows Sleep Mode Right Now

1. Click the **Windows Start** button (bottom-left corner of your screen) and click **Settings** (the gear icon).
2. Click **System**, then click **Power & sleep** (or **Power & battery** on Windows 11).
3. Under **Screen and sleep** (or **Sleep**), change **"When plugged in, put my device to sleep after"** to **Never**.
4. Always keep your laptop plugged into wall power whenever PocketBot is running.

3. How PocketBot Works and Makes Money (Plain English + Exact Math)

Every trade PocketBot considers must survive a strict **4-Stage Filter**. If a setup fails even one stage, PocketBot skips the trade immediately.

Stage 1: The Two-Speed Market Scanner

Different markets have different broker entry fees (called the **Spread**, which is the tiny gap between the Buy price and Sell price). PocketBot divides its 10 markets into two smart tiers:

Tier A — Low-Fee Markets (Checked Every 5 Minutes on M5 Charts):

- **Symbols Watched:** EURUSD (Euro vs US Dollar), GBPUSD (British Pound vs US Dollar), USDJPY (US Dollar vs Japanese Yen), XAUUSD (Spot Gold), SPX (S&P 500 US Index), and NQ (Nasdaq 100 Tech Index).
- **How It Hunts:** Waits for the first 15 minutes of a session to form an "Opening Range" box, then checks every 5 minutes for price to break cleanly above or below that box.

Tier B — High-Fee Fast Movers (Checked Every 15 Minutes on M15 Charts — Strong Momentum Mode):

- **Symbols Watched:** BTCUSD (Bitcoin), ETHUSD (Ethereum), #TSLA (Tesla), and #NVDA (Nvidia).
- **Why 15-Minute Charts?** Brokers charge wider spreads on Crypto and individual stocks (for example, around $120 spread per full Bitcoin). On tiny 5-minute moves, that fee eats your profit. By zooming out to 15-minute charts and demanding a fast, explosive move, the profit target becomes much larger than the fee.
- **All 3 Strong Momentum Rules Must Pass:**
  1. **Relative Spread Rule:** Live spread must be 15% or less of the Stop-Loss distance, AND 1.5x or less of the symbol's normal 14-bar average spread (blocking sudden broker fee spikes during breaking news).
  2. **Speed Surge Rule:** The breakout candle body must be at least 1.5x bigger than the average of the last 14 candles (proving real momentum stepped in, not slow chop).
  3. **No Weak Wicks Rule:** For a Buy trade, the candle must close in the top 25% of its high-to-low bar range (or bottom 25% for a Sell trade). If price shot up and fell halfway back down before closing, sellers rejected it — PocketBot stays out.

Stage 2: The "Time Machine" (10,000 Practice Replays)

Whenever Stage 1 spots a breakout, PocketBot pulls the last **60 days** of live candle data from MetaTrader 5 for that exact symbol and runs **10,000 Monte Carlo computer simulations**.

- It calculates how often that setup hits the **Take-Profit** line first versus hitting the **Stop-Loss** line first.
- **Decision Rule:** If the Expected Value (`avg_R`) across 10,000 simulations is zero or negative, PocketBot cancels the trade automatically.

Stage 3: Auto Lot-Sizing and How MetaTrader 5 Profit Math Actually Works

IMPORTANT — Read This Carefully!
If you have ever used binary-options websites or sports betting apps, you might assume risking "$50" means paying a $50 stake upfront, where a "$100 payout" only gives you $50 of actual profit ($50 stake returned + $50 profit). **MetaTrader 5 does NOT work like binary betting!**

How MetaTrader 5 actually works:

- **You pay $0 upfront stake.** Your entire $10,000.00 remains in your account balance.
- Instead, you gain or lose money based on **how far the price moves** (measured in small price steps called **pips** or **ticks**).
- PocketBot automatically sets your **Take-Profit line TWICE as far away as your Stop-Loss line** (called a **2R** or 2-to-1 Reward-to-Risk ratio), and automatically calculates your exact purchase volume (**Lots**, such as `0.25` lots on EURUSD or `0.05` lots on BTCUSD) so your maximum risk at the Stop-Loss is always capped at **0.5% of your account ($50 on a $10,000 balance)**.

Concrete Example on a $10,000 Account (EURUSD at 0.25 Lots = $2.50 per pip):

- **If the Trade Loses (Price drops 20 pips to Stop-Loss):**
  20 pips x -$2.50 per pip = **-$50.00 pure loss**. Your $10,000 balance becomes **$9,950.00**.
- **If the Trade Wins (Price rises 40 pips to Take-Profit — twice the distance!):**
  40 pips x +$2.50 per pip = **+$100.00 pure profit** added on top of your balance! Your $10,000 balance becomes **$10,100.00**.

Look at what happens over **10 trades** even if PocketBot is **WRONG 60% of the time (6 losses and only 4 wins)**:

Trade Outcome	Price Distance Moved	Pure Profit or Loss per Trade	Count Out of 10 Trades	Total Dollar Impact
Losing Trades (Stop-Loss Hit)	20 pips against you	-$50.00 pure loss	6 losses	6 x -$50 = -$300.00
Winning Trades (Take-Profit Hit)	40 pips in your favor (2x)	+$100.00 pure profit	4 wins	4 x +$100 = +$400.00
NET RESULT AFTER 10 TRADES	**—**	**—**	**10 total trades**	**$10,000 - $300 + $400 = $10,100.00 (+$100 Net)**

Why This Matters: You do NOT need to win 80% of trades to make money. Because winners pay +$100 pure profit while losers stop at -$50, winning just 4 out of 10 trades (40%) puts net profit in your account! Furthermore, if Bitcoin needs a wide $850 Stop-Loss, PocketBot automatically scales your lot size down to `0.05` lots so your maximum dollar loss STILL stays at $50 or less.

Stage 4: The 5 Built-In Safety Circuit Breakers

Before any order is sent to MetaTrader 5, PocketBot checks 5 hard safety locks:

1. **Demo-Only Account Lock:** Verifies `ACCOUNT_TRADE_MODE_DEMO`. Real-money accounts are blocked automatically unless manually unlocked.
2. **-2% Daily Loss Kill-Switch:** Tracks today's closed P/L plus open floating P/L. If daily losses reach -2.0% (-$200 on $10,000), PocketBot halts new trades for the rest of the day.
3. **Maximum 2 Open Positions:** Never opens a 3rd trade while 2 trades are already active.
4. **15% Spread Fee Guard:** Skips any trade if the live bid-ask spread exceeds 15% of the Stop-Loss distance.
5. **Hard Server-Side Stop-Loss and Take-Profit:** Every order attaches its exact S/L and T/P directly on the broker's server. Even if your Wi-Fi disconnects or your PC loses power 5 seconds after entry, the broker server still protects and closes your trade at those exact levels.

4. Overview of the 11 Built-In Agent Skills

Inside the `.agents/skills` folder of PocketBot, 11 specialized Python modules power the workflow:

Skill Name	Role	Function Inside PocketBot
`trader-scanner`	Chart Scanner	Scans M5 and M15 candles for Opening-Range Breakouts and setups.
`trader-entry`	Entry Timer	Verifies exact candle breakout timing and bar closes.
`trader-exit`	Exit Planner	Sets exact Stop-Loss (S/L) and 2R Take-Profit (T/P) levels before entry.
`trader-timemachine`	Time Machine	Runs 10,000 Monte Carlo replays over 60 days of history to check odds.
`trader-budget`	Position Sizer	Uses live MT5 contract specs to size lots for 0.5% max equity risk.
`trader-risk`	Risk Verifier	Enforces all 5 circuit breakers and the 3 Strong Momentum rules.
`trader-broker`	Order Formatter	Builds the MT5 bracket ticket, filling mode (FOK/IOC/RETURN), and logs.
`trader-alerts`	Price Monitor	Updates live MT5 quotes and tracks market session clocks.
`trader-news`	News Monitor	Monitors headlines and sharp intraday price moves on stock symbols.
`trader-analyst`	Earnings Analyst	Checks SEC company filings to avoid blind binary earnings gambles.
`trader-pelosi`	Congress Tracker	Optional research tool tracking public US congressional stock filings.

5. Complete Step-by-Step Setup From Zero (Every Click and Keystroke)

Follow Steps A through E in exact order. Do not skip ahead if an error appears.

Step A: Copy PocketBot From the USB Pendrive to C:\PocketBot

Never run PocketBot directly off the USB pendrive (if the USB drive disconnects, the bot crashes). Copy it onto your main `C:` drive:

1. Plug the USB pendrive into a USB port on your Windows PC.
2. Click the yellow **File Explorer** folder icon on your bottom Windows taskbar.
3. Click your **USB Drive** on the left panel.

4. Right-click the **PocketBot** folder and select **Copy**.
5. Click **This PC** on the left panel, then double-click **Local Disk (C:)**.
6. Right-click an empty white space inside `C:` and select **Paste**.
7. Confirm that your folder path is `C:\PocketBot` (when you open `C:\PocketBot`, you should directly see files such as `mt5_bridge.py`, `mt5_executor.py`, `pocketbot_auto.py`, and the `.bat` launcher files).

Step B: How to Open and Use Windows PowerShell (Zero Experience Needed)

What is PowerShell? PowerShell is Windows' built-in command window where you paste text commands so Windows downloads and configures tools automatically.

1. Press the **Windows key** on your keyboard (bottom-left, next to `Ctrl` and `Alt`).
2. Type **PowerShell** on your keyboard.
3. Click **Windows PowerShell** in the search results. A blue or black text window will open.
4. **How to Copy, Paste, and Run Commands in PowerShell:**
   - Highlight the command in this guide and press **Ctrl + C** to copy it.
   - Click once inside the PowerShell window.
   - Press **Ctrl + V** (or **right-click** your mouse once inside PowerShell) to paste the command.
   - Press **Enter** on your keyboard to execute it.
5. First, unlock PowerShell so it allows local scripts to run. Paste this command and press **Enter**:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned
```

(If PowerShell asks `Do you want to change the execution policy? [Y] Yes...`*, type **Y** and press **Enter**.)*

Step C: Install Python 3.12, Node.js, and Antigravity CLI (agy)

Paste these **three commands ONE AT A TIME** into PowerShell, pressing **Enter** after each one. Wait for each installation to finish before running the next command!

- If PowerShell asks `Do you agree to all the source agreements terms?`, type **Y** and press **Enter**.
- If Windows pops up asking `Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?`, click **Yes**.

1. Install Python 3.12 (runs PocketBot and connects to MetaTrader 5):

```
winget install -e --id Python.Python.3.12
```

2. Install Node.js LTS (supports command-line developer tools):

```
winget install -e --id OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
```

3. Install Google Antigravity CLI (agy — your optional AI mechanic):

```
irm https://antigravity.google/cli/install.ps1 | iex
```

CRITICAL RESTART STEP: Once all three finish installing, **click the X at the top-right corner to close PowerShell completely**. Windows will NOT recognize newly installed tools until you open a fresh PowerShell window in Step E!

Step D: Install MetaTrader 5 and Open Your Free Demo Account

1. Open your web browser (Edge or Chrome) and go to: `https://www.metatrader5.com/en/download`
2. Click **Download MetaTrader 5 for Windows**, run the downloaded installer (`mt5setup.exe`), click **Yes**, and click **Next** -> **Finish** until MetaTrader 5 opens.
3. **Create a Bot-Friendly Free Demo Account (`MetaQuotes-Demo`):**
   - Inside MetaTrader 5, click **File** (top-left menu) -> **Open an Account**.
   - Type **MetaQuotes** in the search box, click **Find your company**, select **MetaQuotes Ltd.**, and click **Next**.
   - Choose **"Open a demo account to trade virtual money without risk"** and click **Next**.
   - Fill in your name, email, and phone number (no ID or bank card required), check **"I agree..."**, and click **Next** -> **Finish**.
   - You now have a free virtual Demo balance (typically $10,000 to $100,000 USD)!
4. **Turn ON the "Algo Trading" Switch Inside MetaTrader 5 (CRITICAL):**
   - At the top menu bar of MetaTrader 5, click **Tools** -> **Options**.
   - Click the **Expert Advisors** tab at the top of the popup window.
   - Check the box **"Allow algorithmic trading"**, then click **OK**.
   - Look at the top toolbar of MetaTrader 5 for the **"Algo Trading"** button: make sure it shows a **GREEN play triangle**. If it shows a red square, click it once to turn it green!
5. **View Your Trade Tab:**
   - Press **Ctrl + T** inside MetaTrader 5 so the bottom Toolbox opens, and select the **Trade** tab on the bottom-left to see your Balance, Equity, and live orders.
6. **Minimize MetaTrader 5 (Click _, DO NOT Click X):**
   - MetaTrader 5 must stay running in the background whenever PocketBot is active!

Step E: Connect C:\PocketBot to Python 3.12 and Test Connection

1. Press the **Windows key**, type **PowerShell**, and open a **brand-new Windows PowerShell** window.
2. *(Note: If your `C:\PocketBot` folder includes `1_FIRST_TIME_SETUP.bat`, you can simply double-click it — OR paste all 4 lines below into PowerShell and press **Enter** to build the Python environment cleanly):*

```
cd C:\PocketBot
& "$env:LOCALAPPDATA\Programs\Python\Python312\python.exe" -m venv .venv
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
python -m pip install MetaTrader5 numpy
```

(Wait 15 to 30 seconds until you see `Successfully installed MetaTrader5...` *and your prompt begins with* `(.venv) PS C:\PocketBot>`*.)*

> **ARM Laptop Note:** Only if you see `No matching distribution found for MetaTrader5`, run `Remove-Item -Recurse -Force .venv` and `winget install -e --id Python.Python.3.12 --architecture x64 --force`, reopen PowerShell, and re-run the 4 lines above.

3. **Run the 3-Second Live Connection Test:** With MetaTrader 5 minimized in the background, paste this line into PowerShell and press **Enter**:

```
python -c "import MetaTrader5 as mt5; print('CONNECTED! Balance: $',
mt5.account_info().balance) if mt5.initialize() else print('FAILED:',
mt5.last_error()); mt5.shutdown()"
```

   - **Success:** It prints `CONNECTED! Balance: $ 100000.0` (or your Demo balance).
   - **If it says FAILED:** Make sure MetaTrader 5 is open and logged into your Demo account, then try again.

6. Daily Use: Running PocketBot With the Easy 1-Click Buttons

Once Section 5 is complete, **you do NOT need PowerShell or AI open for everyday use!**

Daily 10-Second Startup Checklist:

1. Confirm your PC is plugged into power and Windows Sleep is set to **Never**.
2. Open **MetaTrader 5**, check that your Demo balance is visible, check that **Algo Trading** on the top toolbar is **GREEN**, and minimize MetaTrader 5.
3. Open **File Explorer** to `C:\PocketBot` and double-click one of the buttons below:

Button in C:\PocketBot	What Happens When You Double-Click It
`START_AUTO_DEMO.bat` (or `2_START_AUTO_DEMO.bat`)	**Full Auto Demo Mode:** Opens a status window, scans all 10 markets every 5 minutes (M5 tight-spread + M15 Strong Momentum), runs 10,000 Time Machine simulations, verifies all 5 safety brakes, and automatically places Demo bracket orders whenever expected value is positive (`avg_R > 0`).
`START_CONFIRM_MODE.bat` (or `3_START_CONFIRM_MODE.bat`)	**Manual YES/NO Co-Pilot Mode:** Runs the exact same scans, 10,000 replays, and risk math, displays the trade ticket on screen, and waits for you to type **YES** or **NO** + Enter before placing any trade.
`CHECK_STATS.bat` (or `4_CHECK_STATS.bat`)	**Performance Dashboard:** Displays your live MT5 Demo Balance, Equity, Today's Profit/Loss, open positions, closed-trade Win Rate, Profit Factor, and the last 10 log entries from `trader\bot_log.txt`.

How to Stop the Bot or Close a Trade Manually:

- **Stop scanning for new trades:** Click the **X** at the top-right of the black `START_AUTO_DEMO` window (or press **Ctrl + C** inside it).
- **Existing open trades remain protected:** Closing the bot window does NOT delete your Stop-Loss or Take-Profit, because both are stored on the MetaTrader 5 server.
- **Close an open trade immediately:** Open MetaTrader 5, look at the bottom **Trade** tab, and click the small **X** on the far right side of that trade row.

7. Complete PowerShell Command Reference (Manual Control)

If you want to run tests or commands manually in **Windows PowerShell**, always activate `.venv` first:

```
cd C:\PocketBot
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

Once your line starts with `(.venv) PS C:\PocketBot>`, paste any command below:

Action	Exact PowerShell Command
Check MT5 account & live prices	`python mt5_bridge.py status`
View last 12 5-minute candles	`python mt5_bridge.py candles EURUSD XAUUSD SPX NQ --bars 12`
Export live MT5 cache to JSON	`python mt5_bridge.py export EURUSD GBPUSD USDJPY XAUUSD SPX NQ BTCUSD`
Dry-run trade & lot math (no order)	`python mt5_executor.py dry-run --symbol EURUSD --sl-pips 20 --rr 2.0`
Dry-run Strong Momentum on Bitcoin	`python mt5_executor.py dry-run --symbol BTCUSD --simulate-momentum`
Place ONE tiny $2 live demo order	`python mt5_executor.py --symbol EURUSD --sl-pips 20 --rr 2.0 --risk-usd 2.0 --send`
Run 1 scan pass in dry-run mode	`python pocketbot_auto.py --mode demo-auto --once --dry-run`
Run Bot in YES/NO Confirm Mode	`python pocketbot_auto.py --mode confirm`
Run Bot in Full Auto Demo Mode	`python pocketbot_auto.py --mode demo-auto`
View full stats & Profit Factor	`python stats.py`
Emergency stop in PowerShell	Hold **Ctrl** and tap **C** (`Ctrl + C`)

8. How to Use Antigravity CLI (agy — Your Built-In AI Mechanic)

When do you need `agy`?
You **NEVER** need `agy` just to run PocketBot day-to-day. You only open `agy` when you want an AI engineer to adjust settings, map symbol names for a brand-new MT5 broker, or explain your trade logs in plain English!

Step-by-Step Instructions for agy:

1. Open **Windows PowerShell** and enter your `PocketBot` environment:

```
cd C:\PocketBot
.\.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

2. Type **agy** and press **Enter**. *(If PowerShell says `'agy' is not recognized`, run this full path instead:)*

```
& "$env:LOCALAPPDATA\agy\bin\agy.exe"
```

3. **First-Time Sign-In:**
   - Press **Enter** if asked to choose a theme or trust `C:\PocketBot`.
   - Your web browser will open automatically. Sign in with your **Google / Gmail account**, click **Allow**, and return to PowerShell.
4. **How to Talk to `agy`:**
   - Type any plain-English request next to the > prompt at the bottom and press **Enter** (press **Enter** whenever `agy` asks permission to run a command or edit a file).
   - **Helpful Copy-Paste Prompts for `agy`:**
     - *Map symbols on a new MT5 broker:*
       `Check my open MetaTrader 5 account using C:\PocketBot\.venv\Scripts\python.exe, list all available symbols on this server, update mt5_bridge.py so every symbol maps cleanly, and run a dry-run test.`
     - *Change trade risk from 0.5% to 0.25%:*
       `Update mt5_executor.py so default max risk per trade is 0.25% of equity instead of 0.5%, and verify with a dry-run.`
     - *Explain today's bot decisions:*
       `Read trader/bot_log.txt and explain in simple English what PocketBot scanned today and why it took or skipped setups.`
5. **How to Close `agy`:** Hold **Ctrl** and tap **C** twice (`Ctrl + C`, `Ctrl + C`).

9. Troubleshooting Common Errors (Instant Fixes)

- **Error:** `retcode = 10026 (AutoTrading disabled by server)`
  - **Cause:** Some brokers (such as Pocket Option's `PoTrade-MT5` demo server) block automated API trading on demo accounts, or you logged in with a read-only Investor password.
  - **Built-in Fallback:** PocketBot automatically records the trade as a live `[PAPER]` position in `CHECK_STATS.bat` marked to live MT5 prices.

  - **20-Second Fix for Real MT5 Trade-Tab Orders:** Inside MetaTrader 5, click **File -> Open an Account -> MetaQuotes Ltd. -> Open a demo account**. `MetaQuotes-Demo` enables server-side bot execution right away!
- **Error:** `retcode = 10027 (AutoTrading disabled by client)`
  - **Fix:** Look at the top toolbar of MetaTrader 5 — your **Algo Trading** button is red. Click it once so it turns **GREEN**.
- **Error:** `FAILED` **on Connection Check**
  - **Fix:** MetaTrader 5 is closed or logged out. Open MetaTrader 5, verify your Demo balance appears at the bottom, and minimize it (do not close it).
- **Error: Double-clicking** `.bat` **files flashes and closes immediately**
  - **Fix:** Either your original folder still had hardcoded paths from another PC (ask `agy` to convert all paths to relative `%~dp0` paths), or Step E (`.venv` setup) wasn't completed yet. Run the 4-line `.venv` setup block in **Section 5, Step E**.
- **Notice: Specific symbols (like** `#TSLA` **or** `BTCUSD`**) not found**
  - **Cause:** `MetaQuotes-Demo` carries Forex, Metals, and Indices, whereas CFD brokers (like Fusion Markets or Eightcap) also stream Crypto and US Equity CFDs. PocketBot safely skips unavailable symbols without crashing, or `agy` can map your broker's exact tickers in 30 seconds.

10. Honest Limits, Best Trading Hours, and the 50-Trade Rule

Read and follow these rules carefully:

1. **Best Hours to Run PocketBot (New York / Eastern Time — ET):**
   - **Prime Window (8:00 AM to 12:00 PM ET, Monday through Friday):** London and New York sessions overlap, producing the strongest, cleanest directional moves on EURUSD, GBPUSD, USDJPY, XAUUSD (Gold), SPX, NQ, #TSLA, and #NVDA.
   - **Market Closures (Friday 5:00 PM ET to Sunday 5:00 PM ET):** Global Forex, Gold, Stock, and Index markets are **completely closed** all weekend. Only Crypto (`BTCUSD`, `ETHUSD`) moves on weekends if supported by your MT5 server.
2. **Honest Limits — What PocketBot Cannot Do:**
   - **Not a Guaranteed Money Printer:** Losing 3 to 5 trades in a row happens to every systematic strategy on earth. Never judge performance on 2 or 3 trades.
   - **News Shocks & Slippage:** Historical simulations cannot foresee sudden central bank rate shocks or breaking geopolitical news. Fast market gaps can fill slightly past a Stop-Loss ("slippage").
   - **PC Must Stay Awake:** If your PC shuts down, loses Wi-Fi, or enters Sleep mode, PocketBot pauses scanning until restored.
3. **The 50-Trade Graduation Rule (Before Risking $1 of Real Money):**
   - Run PocketBot strictly on **Demo fake money** until `CHECK_STATS.bat` records **at least 50 closed trades**.

- Check the **Profit Factor** in `CHECK_STATS.bat` (Total Dollars Won divided by Total Dollars Lost):
  - **Below 1.00:** Strategy is losing money — keep testing on Demo.
  - **1.00 to 1.29:** Near break-even — stay on Demo.
  - **1.30 or higher after 50+ trades:** Strong positive edge ($1.30+ won per $1.00 lost).
- If you ever choose to trade live capital later, use a regulated broker in your country with reliable withdrawals, start tiny ($200 to $500 at `0.01` lot risk), and never risk money needed for rent, bills, or essentials.

Disclaimer: Educational and technical software documentation only — not financial or investment advice. Retail leveraged trading involves substantial risk of loss.